



Mimics

Mimics (Mimicus Inanimata) are well known for their ability to imitate inanimate objects. Primarily ambush predators, mimics have the uncanny ability to replicate objects most likely to attract prey. Given their amorphous physiology, mimics are typically categorized by size; however, it is also worthwhile considering subtypes within each size category, as mimics in certain environments have evolved to specialize.

Often considered a harmless pest in dense urban environments, and a solved problem in the wilder areas of the world, mimics are more complex and varied than most people know. As long as a mimic can predate undisturbed, it grows in size with no observed limit, leading some to wonder just how large they can really get.

"Quickly boy! How many SPOONS did we have yesterday?!" –Ferus, the Ever-Vigilant



Surprise! When fighting only mimics, heroes always go last and roll Initiative with disadvantage.

Book Mimic LVL 3, TINY

Read THIS! (Reach 3) 1d4+4, on hit: Too Close!

Too Close! Blinded until they escape (DC 11). Move with them and your attacks can't be Interposed. You take half damage from attacks (they take the other half).

Stories of possessed books are well known among scholars, these are usually Book Mimics, looking to feast on a sleep-deprived mage.

Remember! Attacks by invisible (or undetected) monsters have advantage, as do attacks against Grappled, Blinded or Restrained creatures!

Clothing Mimic LVL 4, SMALL

Enwrap. (Reach 4) Pull yourself toward a target, attack for 1d6+6 damage and Worn.

Worn. They are Restrained until they escape (DC 12). Move with your target, your attacks can't be Interposed, and you take half damage from attacks (they take the other half).

Clothing Mimics often feature in bedtime stories meant to discipline messy kids. They are quite real, however. These mimics have been reported to imitate everything from warm clothing in cold regions, to fashionable garbs in big cities.

Treasure Chest Mimic LVL 5

A Treasure Chest! (Optional) Heroes make a WIL save, the lowest is tempted to open it!

Ambusher. Deal +10 damage on your first attack in an encounter.

- **Pseudopod (2x).** (Reach 6) 1d6. On hit Grappled (escape DC 13, can Grapple multiple creatures). OR:
- **Bite.** (a Grappled or adjacent creature) Pull them toward you then deal 2d12+10 damage.

The common Chest Mimic was historically very effective against adventurers, making it infamous. In time however, its main prey learned to avoid it, and it has since become endangered.

Door Mimic LVL 10, LARGE (ESCAPE DC: 15)

Totally a Real Door! Has heavy armor (and can't attack) on one side. Opens as a door normally, after some in the party pass through slam shut splitting the party, attacking the heroes on the unarmored side.

Ambusher. Deal +20 damage on your first attack in an encounter.

- **Pseudopod (2x).** (Reach 8) 1d12. OR:
- **Bite.** (a Grappled or adjacent creature) Pull them toward you then deal 2d12+20 damage.

Unlock. DC 15 Finesse check (rolling with disadvantage) or audibly unlocks when bloodied.

PIT TRAP MIMIC ANY LVL, SOLO HUGE

Perfectly Normal Hallway... Appears as a trivial to jump pit initially, as heroes attempt to cross, roll initiative! Pull the hero who rolled the lowest into the Pit and Bite!

Ambusher. Deal +2x LVL damage on your first attack.

Actions. After each hero's turn, pull a Grappled hero 4 spaces then choose one:

- **Bite.** (Reach 0) 1d6+LVL to all in the Pit (doesn't miss).
- **Pseudopod.** (Reach 12) 1d6+LVL damage. On hit: Grappled (escape DC 10+1/2 LVL).

BLOODIED: Swinging Blades. At half HP, trigger swinging blades on each side above the Pit. Any creature adjacent to the Pit (being pulled in or climbing out) suffers LVL damage on a failed DEX save.

LAST STAND: At 0 hp, the Mimic is dying! 10xLVL more damage and it dies. Until then the floor on both sides of the Pit slopes downward, before each hero's turn, move them 3 spaces nearer the Pit!

Escape! Heroes can attempt to escape the Pit any way that makes sense. Spending an action to pull others out (must go Prone to reach them without rope), teleporting, flying, jumping, or any appropriate skill check (DC 10+1/2 level) rolled with disadvantage since the mimic is STICKY!

This Mimic is classified as highly mature, having obtained enough size to imitate complex architecture and the surrounding area.

Use Pseudopod to Grapple lots of heroes, and only use Bite minimally. You can allow them to break a Grapple when crit.

Bite as much as possible, try to get multiple heroes in the Pit at once to deal tons of damage!

RUNNING MIMICS

- **Ambushers.** Mimics are ambush predators so their first attacks deal incredible amounts of damage; however, their subsequent attacks are often much weaker.
- **Surprise the Heroes.** Chest Mimics are classic, but don't forget to be versatile with their placement. Be creative, if YOU were a mimic, where would you hide?
- **Outside Combat.** If harmed outside of combat, mimics will quietly take up to half their HP in damage without revealing their true nature. Warn heroes who go around damaging random chests, doors, etc. any treasure in there could also be damaged, or they may attract unwanted attention by making so much noise.
- **Play into Paranoia.** Mimics are universal monsters that can be used in almost any setting, from classic treasure chests inside dungeons to teacups or paintings in a castle. A single, well-placed mimic can make a hero suspicious of outhouses or beds forever!